protested the demand for tax but ‘the government did not heed their word. Then Mahatma Gandhiji took the matter into his hands and held a meeting. He explained to the people that if they refused to pay the tax their land would be confiscated, and asked them if they were prepared for that’.[9] It is the repeated compromise that Bhagat Singh resented, and this is why on 2 February 1931 he was still as defiant as ever and wrote that ‘[w]e should not have any illusion about the possibilities, failures and achievements of Congress movement’ which should ‘be better stamped Gandhianism’. For him, ‘[i]t does not stand for freedom avowedly; it is in favour of “Partnership” – a strange interpretation of what “complete independence” signifies. Its method is novel, and but for the helplessness of the people’,’ he was convinced that ‘Gandhianism would gain no adherent . . .’. What he meant by this was that ‘[i]t has fulfilled the role of an intermediate party’ which is ‘controlled mostly by men with stakes in the country, who prize their stakes with bourgeoisie tenacity . . .’.[10] Therefore, ‘[in a sense Gandhianism’ is a creed that ‘counts on mass action, though not for the masses alone’.[11] On the other hand, Bhagat Singh’s philosophy was that ‘[w]hat we mean by Revolution is quite plain. In this century it can only mean one thing – the capture of the political power by the masses for the masses’. Indeed, ‘[t]he proletariat revolution is the only weapon of India to dislodge the Imperialist’.[12]